

TOPIC 2: DEMOCRACY AND HUMAN RIGHTS

1. Relationship Between Democracy and Human Rights

Democracy and human rights support each other. In a democracy, leaders are chosen by the people and must respect the law and fundamental rights (life, dignity, expression, association, fair hearing, etc.). Human rights limit what government may do and protect minorities and individuals from abuse.

2. How Democracy Protects Rights

- Free press and speech allow criticism and exposure of abuse.
- Independent courts can enforce rights against the state.
- Elections allow citizens to change bad governments.
- Civil society and opposition parties watch those in power.

3. How Rights Support Democracy

Without freedom of expression, association and fair process, elections and public debate become meaningless. Rights make democratic participation possible and meaningful.

4. Summary

Democracy without rights can become majority tyranny; rights without democratic accountability can remain paper promises. Together they form the basis of free and just society.

End of Topic 2